

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager who maps complexity and ships.*

Positioning, ten years of translating ambiguous operational systems into dev-ready backlogs, now bringing that muscle to Ingenious Lion's emerging product landscape.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY INGENIOUS LION

Ingenious Lion sits at the intersection of data infrastructure and marketing technology for one of the largest agency groups in the world – a surface area where the product work is genuinely difficult, not just cosmetically complex. The job description is honest that the landscape is still being defined, and that the incoming PM needs to absorb what exists before improving it. That matches exactly how I operate: I map first, then structure, then ship. The explicit expectation that this person will "create structure where there is currently ambiguity" is not a warning for me – *it is the operating mode I have practised across defence programmes, InsurTech platforms, and public-sector analytics.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, specification drafting, edge-case generation, requirements analysis
- **GPT**, stakeholder-facing summaries and workshop preparation
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted code review and technical spec validation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping before engineering commitment
- **Framer**, design-heavy stakeholder artefacts
- **Gamma.app**, roadmap and strategy decks

- **n8n**, workflow automation and agentic process design

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, AngularJS, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, OpenShift, Argo Workflows, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, Docker, Ionic, CGM API integration, Shopware, low-code insurance platforms, Jira, Azure DevOps.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT INGENIOUS LION

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Conduct structured intake sessions with the Business Product Manager and engineering leads to produce a written map of what is live, what is in flight, and where ownership is currently unclear – grounded in the actual product landscape described in the posting.

WEEK 2

Backlog, structure, criteria.

Triage the existing backlog, assign work breakdown structures and acceptance criteria to the highest-priority items, and surface the three most critical blockers to stakeholder communication.

WEEK 3+

Align, ship, track.

Own the dependency register, run weekly delivery syncs, and push the first structured sprint through to a clean release – closing the loop between the business and engineering sides.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Ingenious Lion team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role at the JAY! D Hub. The description lands with precision: a product landscape still being defined, an engineering team that needs a counterpart who holds context and translates requirements rather than hands off tickets, and a Business Product Manager who owns the client side while the Technical PM owns delivery. That division of labour is the model I have worked in throughout my career, and it is the model I find most effective.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I joined a defence-grade AI data platform mid-flight, under FCAS – a programme with multinational stakeholders, incomplete documentation, and months of accumulated technical debt. My first task was the same one this posting names: absorb what exists, map what is missing, and create a structure the team can execute against. Within the first weeks I had a written dependency map and a prioritised backlog with acceptance criteria. Within a month I had unblocked an infrastructure issue in OpenShift that had been open for over a year, delivered autonomously in one week. I am not citing that to impress – I cite it because it is the same mechanic this role requires: rapid comprehension of a complex system, followed by structured execution.

At Emil Group, the situation was different but the problem was recognisable. A 17-person team had lost sprint discipline under delivery pressure, client trust was eroding, and senior engineers were leaving. I split the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, rebuilt weekly product workshops with the client, and reduced attrition from near-total to a single departure. The Business Product Manager / Technical PM dynamic described in this posting requires exactly that kind of dual attention: keeping the engineering side disciplined and the business side informed without either becoming the bottleneck.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I served as Deputy IT Security Officer alongside the PM role, owned a Kubernetes migration, and introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipelines on a public-facing analytics platform. The combination of delivery management, technical depth, and stakeholder communication across non-technical audiences is not a stretch for me – it is how I have operated in every role.

On the AdTech and media domain: I do not have direct AdTech career experience, and I would rather name that clearly than obscure it. What I bring is strong pattern recognition across data-intensive platform products, and the ability to absorb a new domain quickly – which is precisely what the posting is asking for in the first weeks.

I am a German native, C2 English, based in Berlin, and available on four weeks' notice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

§ BEARING

Technical Product Manager and Product Owner with ten years of experience absorbing complex product landscapes and turning ambiguity into structured, executable backlogs. Background spans AI data platforms under government contract, B2B SaaS InsurTech, public-sector analytics, and mobile healthcare applications. Comfortable as the delivery-side counterpart to a business-facing PM: owns technical specification, backlog management, dependency tracking, and engineering alignment. Operates in environments where requirements are incomplete, priorities shift, and the team needs a single person who holds context and keeps delivery moving.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Rapid absorption of complex, underdocumented product landscapes
 - Backlog ownership: work breakdown structures, estimates, acceptance criteria
 - Cross-functional alignment across engineering, business, and non-technical stakeholders
 - Dependency management across multiple parallel workstreams
 - Sprint discipline, velocity tracking, and structured refinement practices
 - Technical depth sufficient to unblock engineers without becoming a bottleneck
 - AI-native tooling for specification, prototyping, and delivery acceleration
 - Stakeholder communication under pressure: risks, blockers, and progress
 - Founder-level pragmatism: low ego, high agency, comfort in ambiguity
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Absorbed a mid-flight defence-grade AI data platform (FCAS), mapped existing architecture, and structured the backlog for a cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Unblocked an OpenShift infrastructure issue independently that had been open for over a year; delivered in one week as sole developer

- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Managed multinational stakeholders across business and technical sides; responsible for data transformation, transparency, and audit trails
- Implemented SafeAI and ExplainableAI concepts for ML training and evaluation on curated multimodal datasets

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Owned the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform, managing backlog, delivery tracking, and stakeholder communication across technical and non-technical audiences
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline on a delivery-pressured B2B SaaS platform: split a 17-person team into focused Scrum units and reintroduced velocity tracking, structured refinement, and ownership concepts
- Rebuilt client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly product workshops and transparent stakeholder communication
- Delivered the Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure
- Managed backlog and delivery tracking across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for a mobile-first hospital pilot app across iOS and Android: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage
- Managed dependencies across legacy external APIs and hospital information system integration under tight deadlines
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product built on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware; deputy IT security officer
- Defined backup, restore/checkpoint, and encryption product roadmap; targeted sub-two-minute setup with no technical knowledge required

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Founded a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone; owned full UX/UI design, PSP integration, and mobile app prototype
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE, ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware, including complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policies

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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